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Long COVID also taking toll on kids

Debilitating symptoms keep many from school, and activity in general



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

‘She just was a shell of a person for such a long time.’

ANDREA JOAQUIM,
talking about her
daughter Kaylee’s
struggles with
long COVID

By Aayushi Datta
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

The field trip was supposed to be fun. A few weeks ago, 16-year-old Kaylee Joaquim woke up early to tour the University of Massachusetts Dartmouth campus with her high school classmates — the kind of outing she hadn’t attended in a long time.

But after a day spent walking and climbing stairs, she returned home exhausted. The trip left her bedridden and in pain for a week. “That was the worst day of the year,” Joaquim said earlier this month, as she leaned back into a comfortable armchair in her living room. “I’m never going on a field trip again. . . . That’s kind of sad.”

For Joaquim, a student at South Shore Charter Public School, life changed dramatically after she developed long COVID in 2022.

Defined as a chronic condition that lasts for at least three months after a COVID infection,

long COVID is diagnosed not by a single test but by a pattern of symptoms that cannot otherwise be explained. Those symptoms can include fatigue, headaches, brain fog, sleep disruption, and pain, but they often look different depending on age.

Researchers are still gaining new insight into how it affects the youngest patients.

“Children do get long COVID, but it doesn’t always look the same as it does in adults,” said Melissa Stockwell, division chief of child and adolescent health at Columbia University and a lead researcher with the pediatric cohort of the National Institutes of Health’s RECOVER initiative, a program created to better understand and treat long COVID.

Researchers with the program published a study last year that estimated long COVID potentially affects nearly 6 million children in the United States, which would make it more com-

COVID, Page A8

At her worst, Kaylee Joaquim slept on the couch because climbing the stairs was too much for her.

Chef accused of killing his wife

Beaten body found in hotel room at UMass Amherst

By Shelley Murphy
and Nick Stoico
GLOBE STAFF

AMHERST — A celebrated chef at the University of Massachusetts Amherst was charged Thursday with murdering his wife in a hotel room on campus, stunning students and staff at the state’s flagship university.

Jeffrey C. MacDonald, 36, allegedly told police he beat Emma MacDonald, 31, to death on Wednesday night, police said in a report filed in Eastern Hampshire District Court. Emma MacDonald was also a dining services employee, according to campus payroll records.

Nearly two years ago, another woman lodged abuse allegations against him, court records show.

On Wednesday, after being read his rights, MacDonald “admitted that he had intentionally beaten his wife to death, using his hands, feet, as well as a variety of other objects, and that it was his intent to kill her in doing so,” police said in the report.

MacDonald, of Wilbraham, pleaded not guilty Thursday to first-degree murder, and assault and battery on a police officer.

Judge Rebecca Michaels ordered him held without bail and slated a probable cause hearing for May 12. She granted a request by MacDonald’s court-appointed lawyer, Jonah Goldsmith, to order an evaluation of MacDonald’s competency to stand trial. Goldsmith did not respond to a request for comment.

As the campus winds down spring semester, news of the killing at the Hotel UMass rattled students.

Lena Nowak, a biology student, said she shivered as she walked past the hotel’s sign.

“I feel pretty safe here still, SLAYING, Page A8

Vrabel’s troubles becoming a big distraction for Patriots



Questions about the coach continue to multiply.

Mike Vrabel has so far escaped professional consequence for his Arizona antics. He is not facing any

►Vrabel will miss Day 3 of draft. C1.

sort of investigation from the NFL or the Patriots for the clandestine tryst with a national NFL reporter. In truth, there is no crime to punish.

But that hasn’t stopped the tentacles of the ongoing saga from reaching into Vrabel’s ability to do his job, with the hard evidence com-

TARA SULLIVAN
COMMENTARY

ing as he confirmed before the draft Thursday that he will miss Day 3 of the NFL Draft while seeking counseling. As he briefly took questions at Gillette Stadium, his words were quite a long way from his initial statement (lie) to the New York Post, which published the now-infamous photos of him with The Athletic reporter Dianna Russini. Back then,

Vrabel dismissed the interaction as “completely innocent,” going so far as to call it “laughable” that anyone would suggest otherwise. The laughs are on him now, as the Post continues a near-daily barrage of photos of the couple canoodling.

And now, here he is, “seeking counseling,” a revelation that comes a day after he broke his silence with a small group of reporters at Gillette Stadium, when he acknowledged having “some difficult conversations” with important people in his

life.

The Patriots have to know they have a credibility problem on their hands.

The questions continue to multiply rather than disappear, no matter how many PR wheels they try to spin.

Seriously, was the off-site counseling appointment only available on the weekend? If the counseling is, as Vrabel wants us to believe, the priority above all else, then why not

SULLIVAN, Page C7

‘These are really dangerous jobs that aren’t sold as dangerous jobs.’

CITY COUNCILOR SHARON DURKAN

Effect of Boston’s new rules for delivery drivers unclear

Liability insurance requirement intended to promote safety

By Claire Thornton
GLOBE STAFF

Food delivery drivers struggling to make ends meet could see their jobs become even more difficult in Boston after new city rules went into effect last week.

The rules, chiefly adopted to address reports of dangerous driving, require major third-party delivery companies to secure a permit to operate in Boston and obtain liability insurance protecting their drivers, other motorists, and pedestrians in the event of an accident. The ordinance, approved last year, went into ef-

fect April 11.

But because the new rules focus heavily on financial protections, there could be unintended consequences for drivers, according to several urban traffic experts who study third-party delivery logistics. The ordinance doesn’t prevent companies from passing some of the insurance costs onto drivers, cutting into their earnings, researchers said.

“There are lots of different potential outcomes that could come from what might otherwise seem to be a pretty straightforward policy intervention,” said Jason Jackson, an urban planning professor at MIT whose work focuses on digital platform economies.

A spokesperson for Mayor Michelle Wu said large food delivery companies DELIVERIES, Page A9



CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

Experts wonder if food delivery drivers will have to absorb some of the new insurance costs, or be incentivized to drive faster to complete orders.

More than 207,000 Boston-area workers and 260,000 statewide are likely to lose their jobs to AI systems over the next five years, according to a new study. B5.

Anna Maria College is closing its doors, the latest small Massachusetts school to succumb to financial difficulties. B1.

President Trump has ordered the US military to “shoot and kill” small Iranian boats that deploy mines in the Strait of Hormuz. A3.

The Bruins dropped Game 3 to Buffalo, while the Red Sox were swept by the Yankees, wasting Payton Tolle’s brilliant start. C1.



Current event

Friday: Still cool, breezy. High 51-56. Low 39-44.

Saturday: More of the same. High 48-53. Low 40-45.

Sunrise: 5:49 Sunset: 7:36
Weather and Comics, G6-7.

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